Center Midfields Defensive

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Player counts

In this project, there are a total of 83 defensive center midfields considered, with

- 21 center midfields in 12 teams in the English FA Women's Super League
- 19 center midfields in 12 teams in the German Frauen Bundesliga
- 26 center midfields in 16 teams in the Spanish Liga F
- 17 center midfields in 10 teams in the Italian Serie A Women

Results

Results for 2 clusters

Breakdown of results by league

league	FA Women's Super League	Frauen Bundesliga	Liga F	Serie A Women
kmeans_2_cluster				
0	9	7	11	9
1	12	12	15	8

The split is slightly biased towards cluster 1, execpt for Italy's Serie A Women.

Breakdown of results by features

- Cluster 0 midfielders made more passes and carries forward, especially passes into the final third, won more fouls while defending and progress mainly with passes.
- On the other hand, cluster 1 midfielders made more passes backward on the ground, carried more into the final at higher speed, received and performed defensive actions at higher positions at greater variance, specifically with counterpresses in opposition half. They progressed more by carrying than cluster 0.

Therefore, based on these results,

- Cluster 0 center midfielders can be seen as deep defensive midfielders, which align closely to a traditional number 6 player in football.
- Cluster 1 center midfielders can be seen as more advanced dynamic defensive midfielders which can resemble a Segundo Volante.

Breakdown of results by players

Findings and radar plots for each defensive center midfielder are in their own files:

- Sophie Ingle - Chelsea
- Kim Little - Arsenal
- Clare Wheeler - Everton
- Lia Walti - Arsenal

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Appendix

Radar plots for 2 clusters center midfields' averages

All leagues

Passing

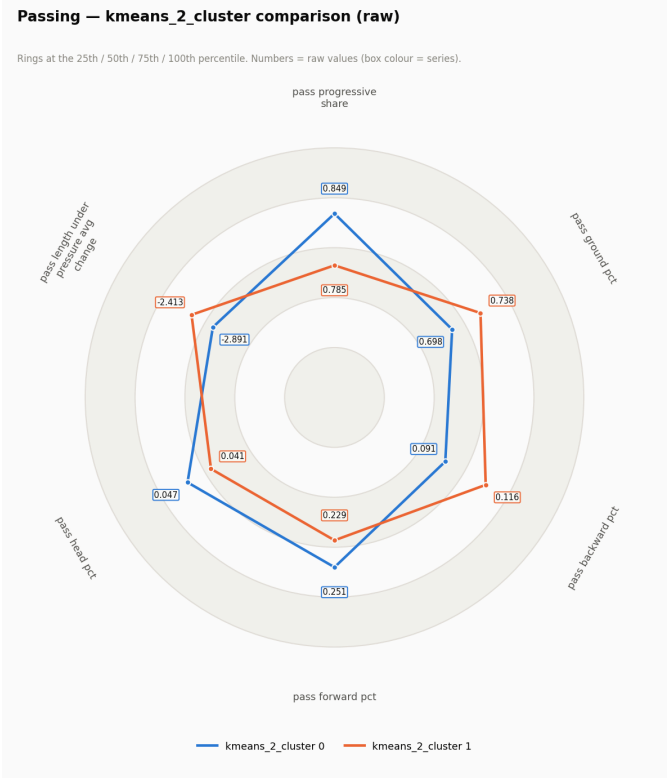


Figure 1: Center Midfields Defensive Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

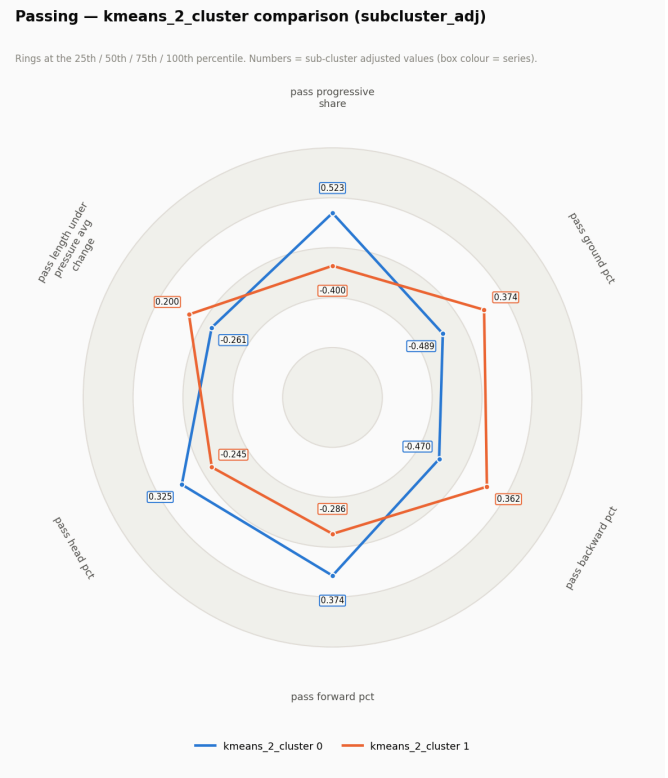


Figure 2: Center Midfields Defensive Passing — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt & Dribbling

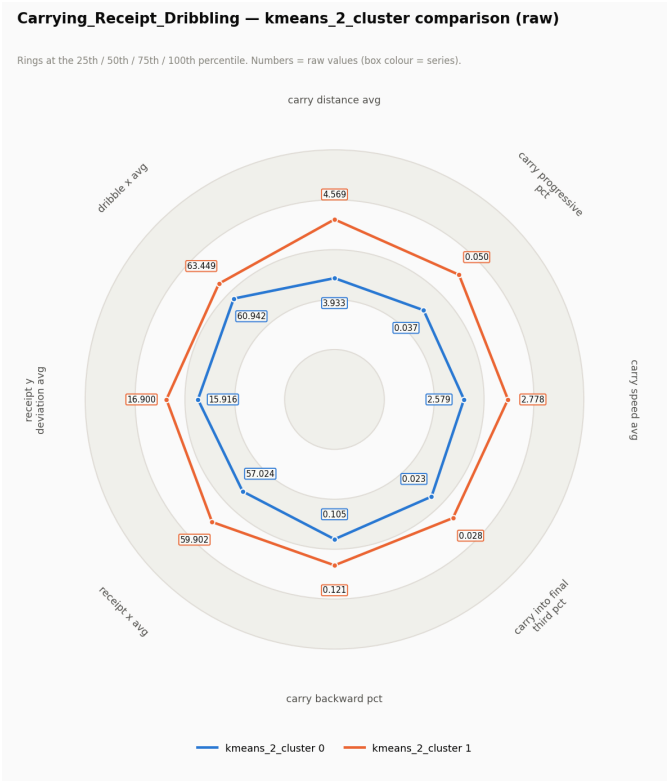


Figure 3: Center Midfields Defensive Carrying, Receipt & Dribbling — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

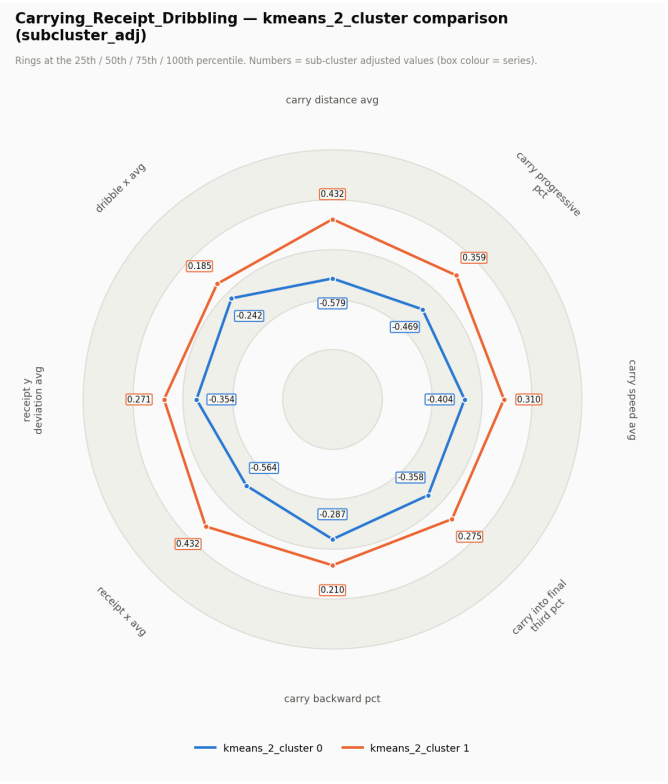


Figure 4: Center Midfields Defensive Carrying, Receipt & Dribbling — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

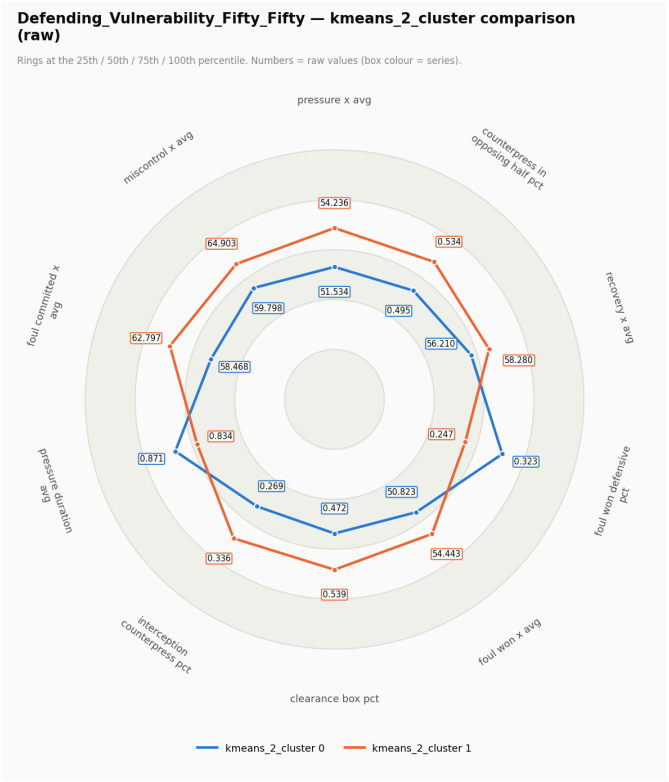


Figure 5: Center Midfields Defensive Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

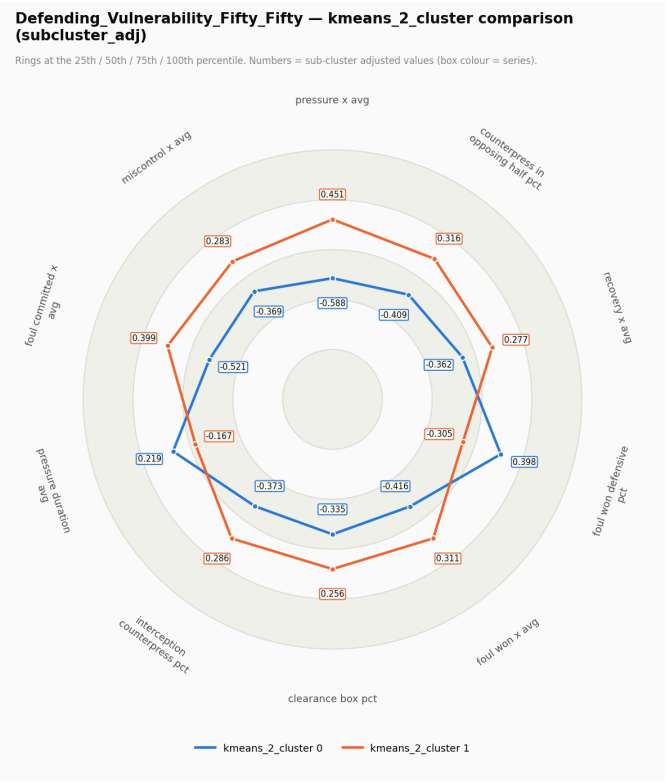


Figure 6: Center Midfields Defensive Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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FA Women's Super League

Passing

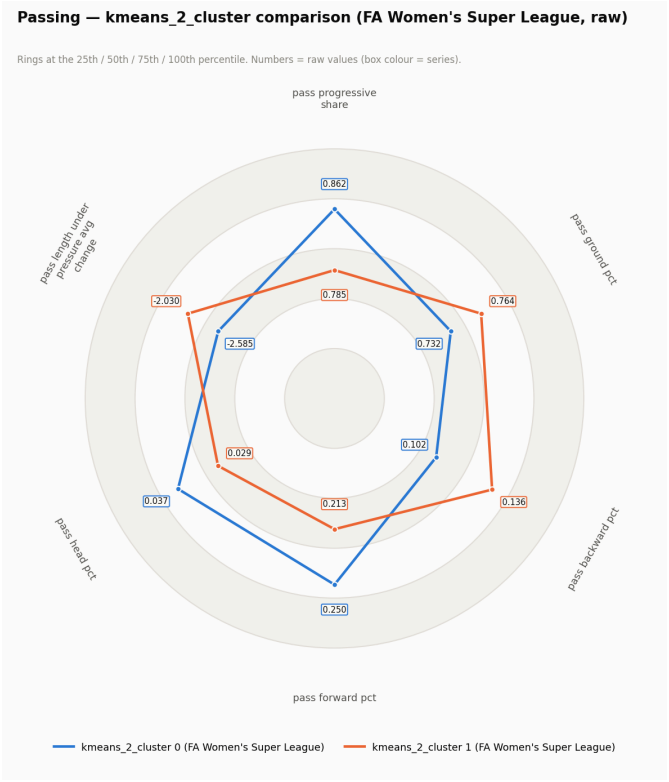


Figure 7: England Center Midfields Defensive Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

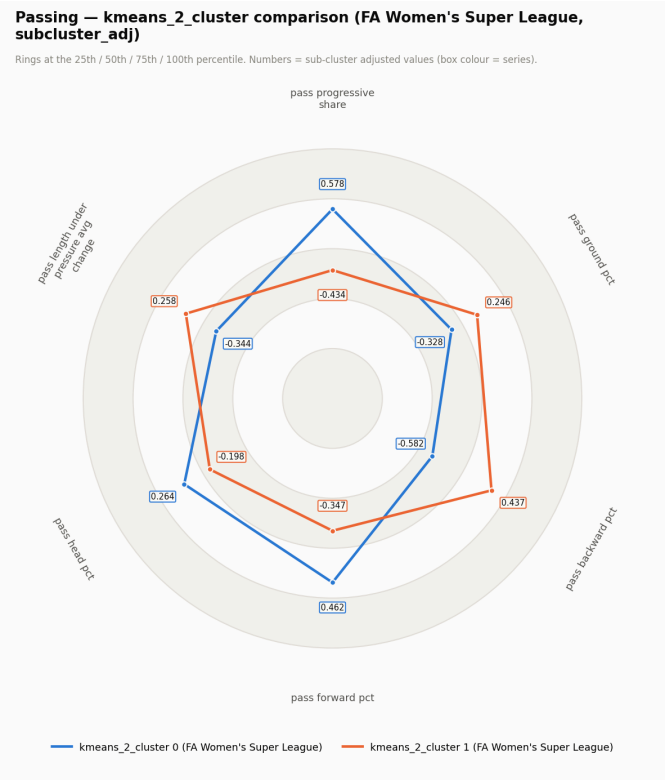


Figure 8: England Center Midfields Defensive Passing — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt & Dribbling

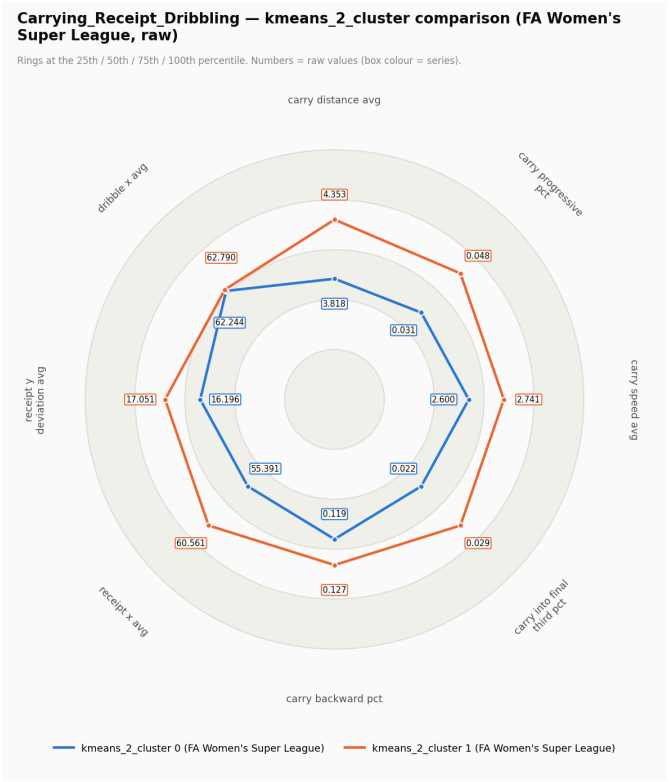


Figure 9: England Center Midfields Defensive Carrying, Receipt & Dribbling — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

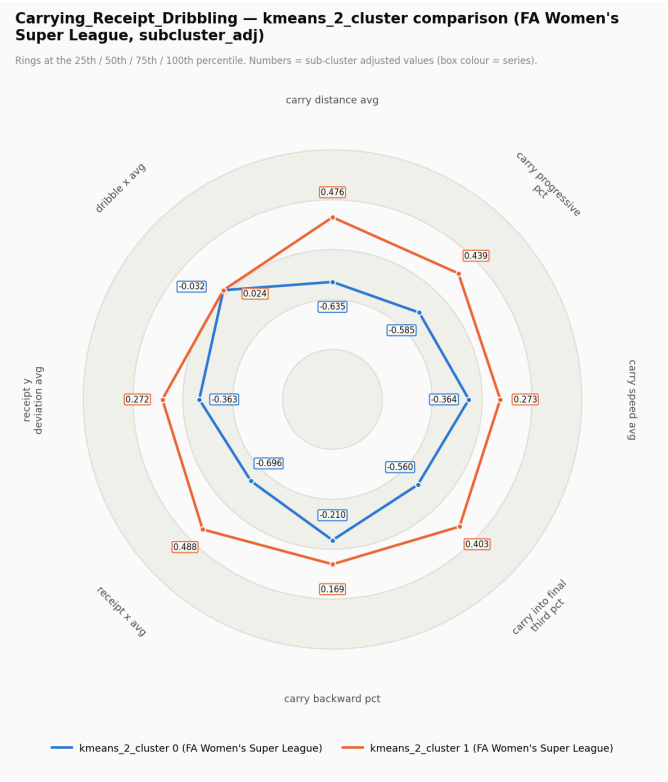


Figure 10: England Center Midfields Defensive Carrying, Receipt & Dribbling — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

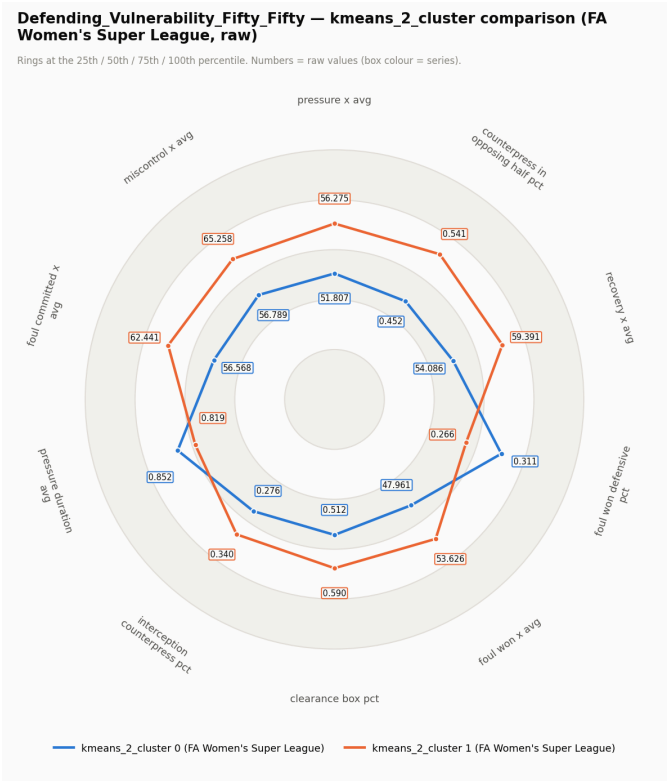


Figure 11: England Center Midfields Defensive Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

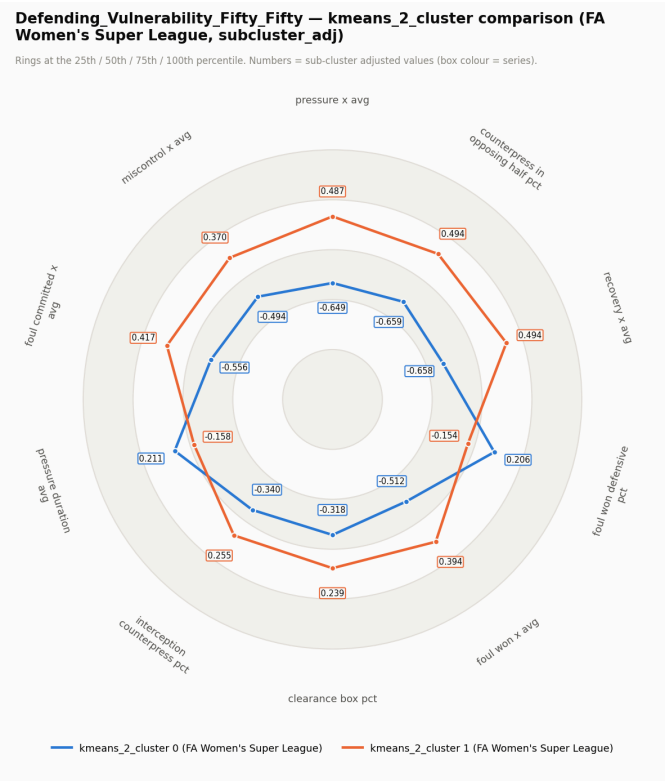


Figure 12: England Center Midfields Defensive Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Frauen Bundesliga

Passing

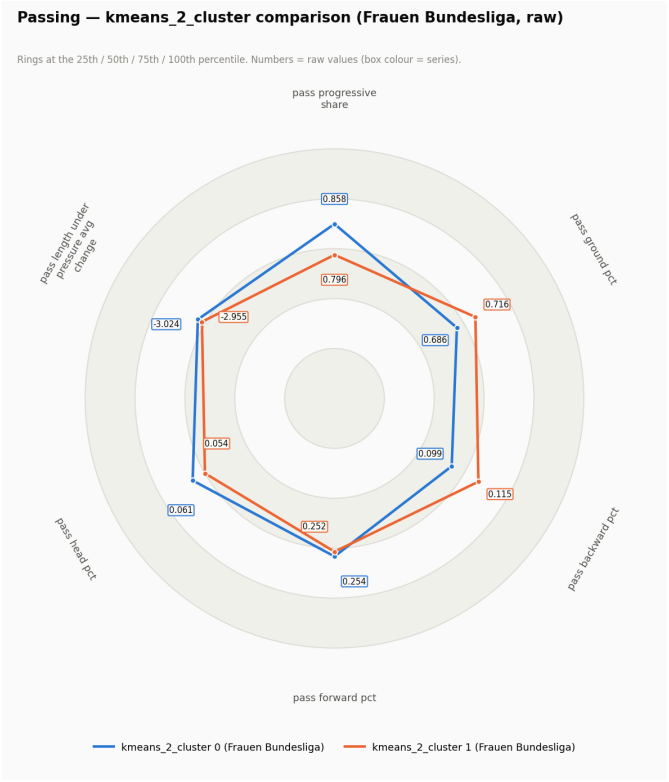


Figure 13: Germany Center Midfields Defensive Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

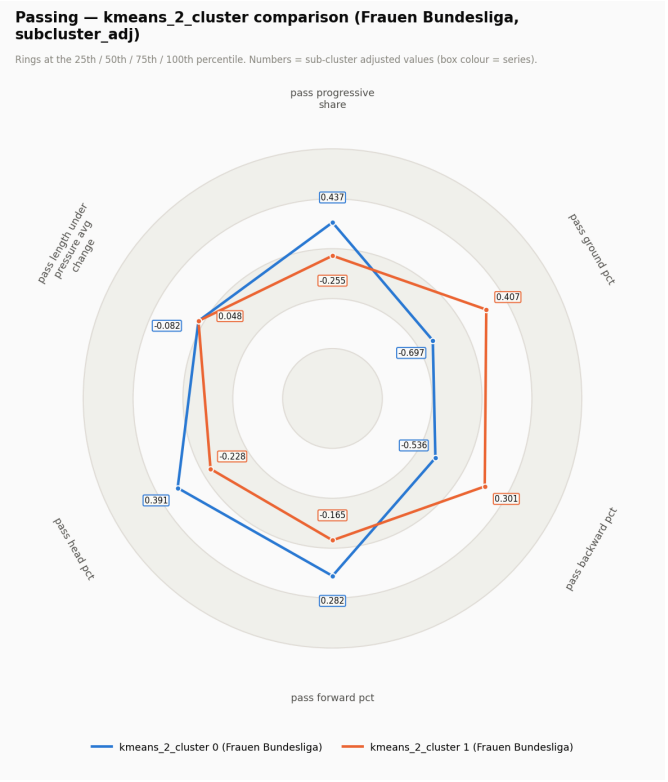


Figure 14: Germany Center Midfields Defensive Passing — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt & Dribbling

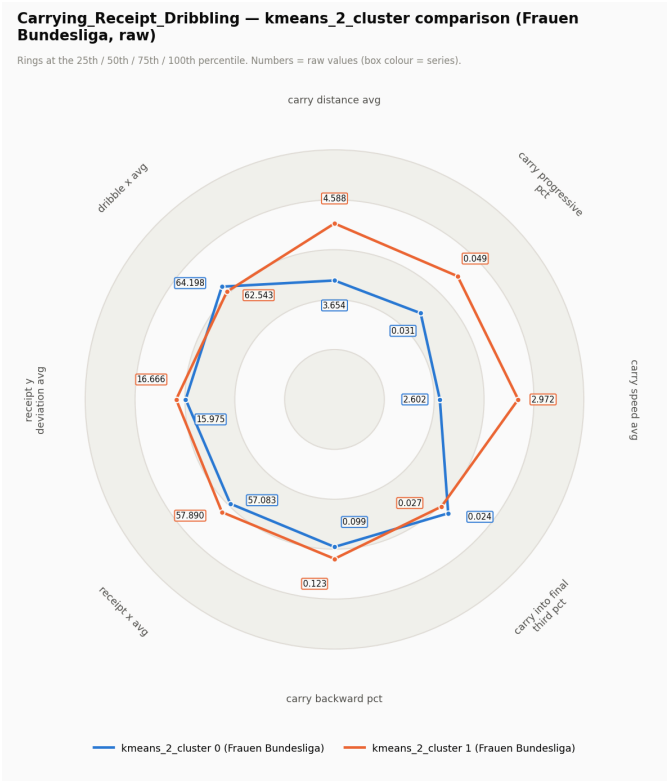


Figure 15: Germany Center Midfields Defensive Carrying, Receipt & Dribbling — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

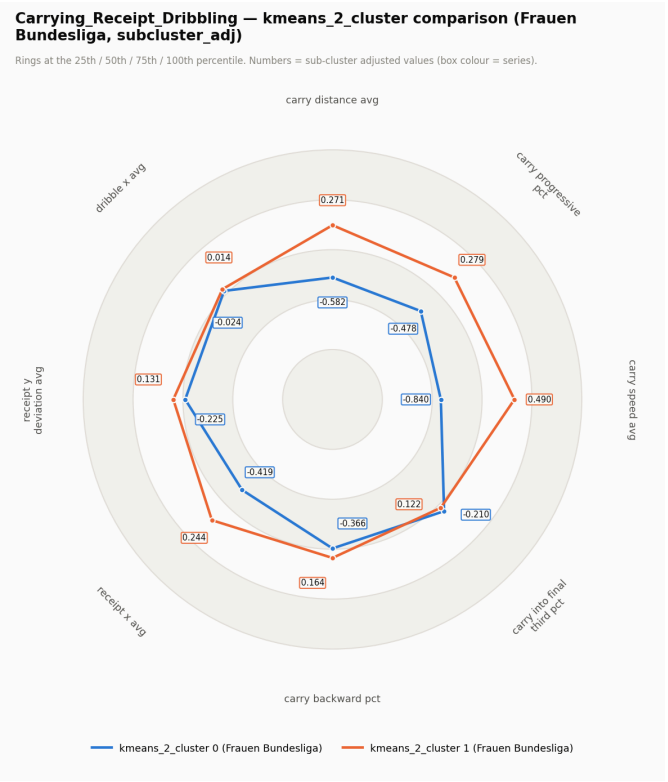


Figure 16: Germany Center Midfields Defensive Carrying, Receipt & Dribbling — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

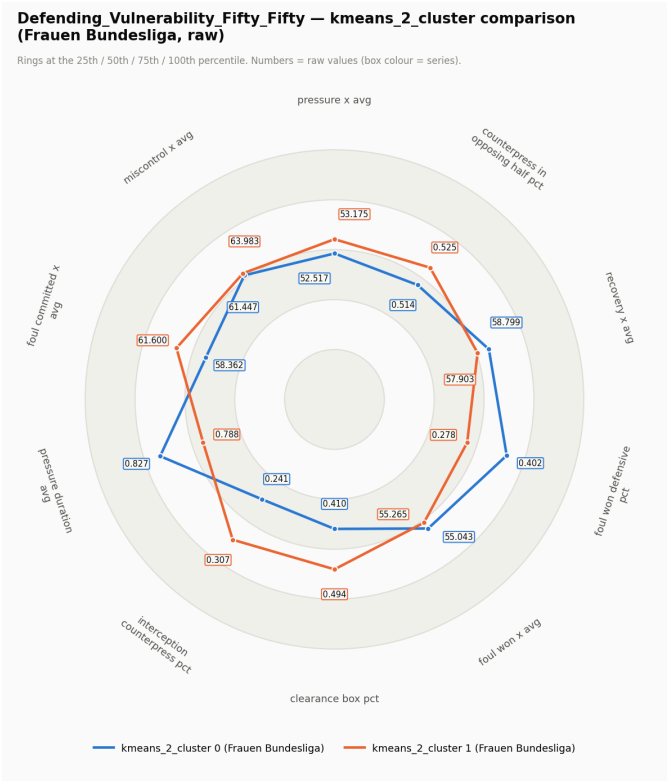


Figure 17: Germany Center Midfields Defensive Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

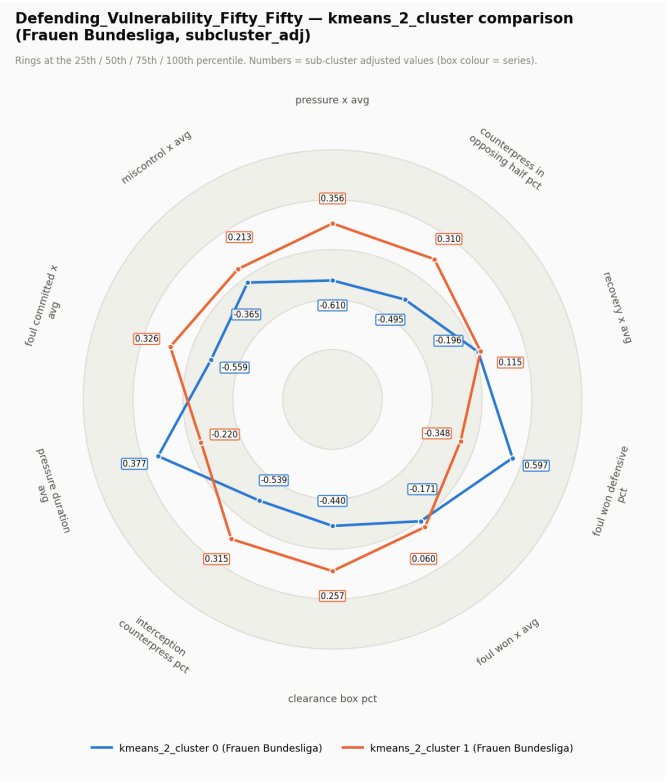


Figure 18: Germany Center Midfields Defensive Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Liga F

Passing

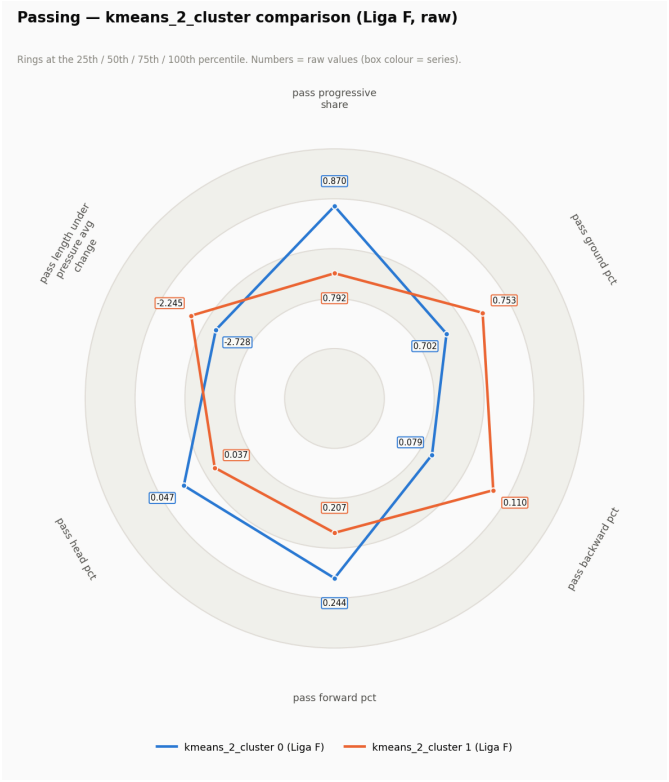


Figure 19: Spain Center Midfields Defensive Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

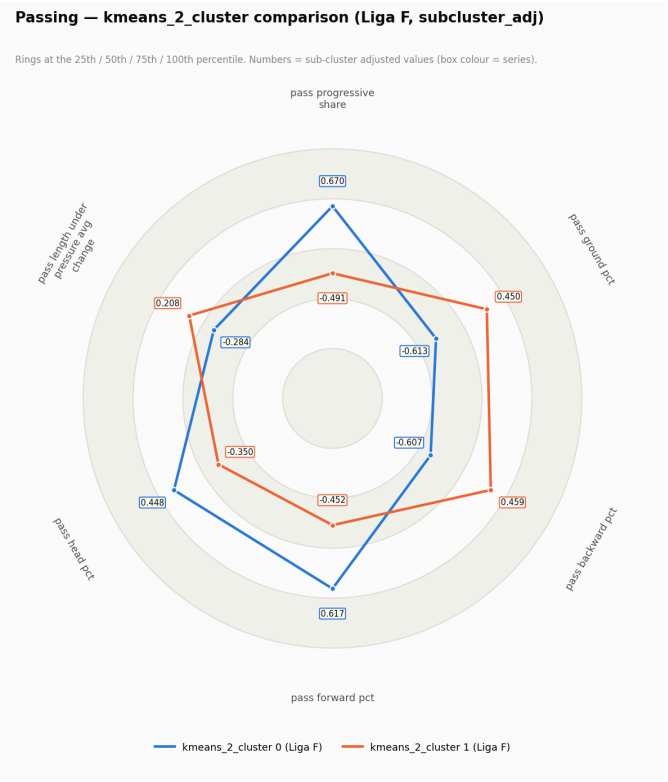


Figure 20: Spain Center Midfields Defensive Passing — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt & Dribbling

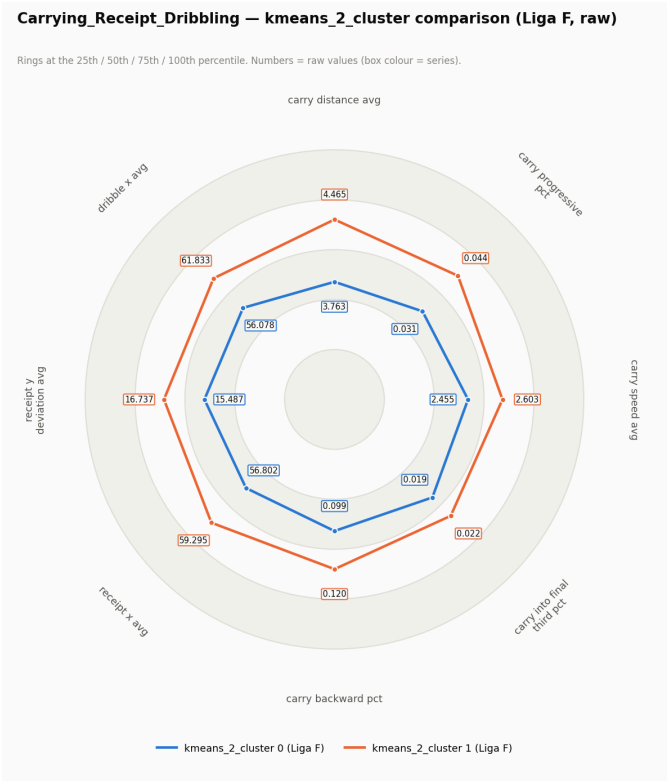


Figure 21: Spain Center Midfields Defensive Carrying, Receipt & Dribbling — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

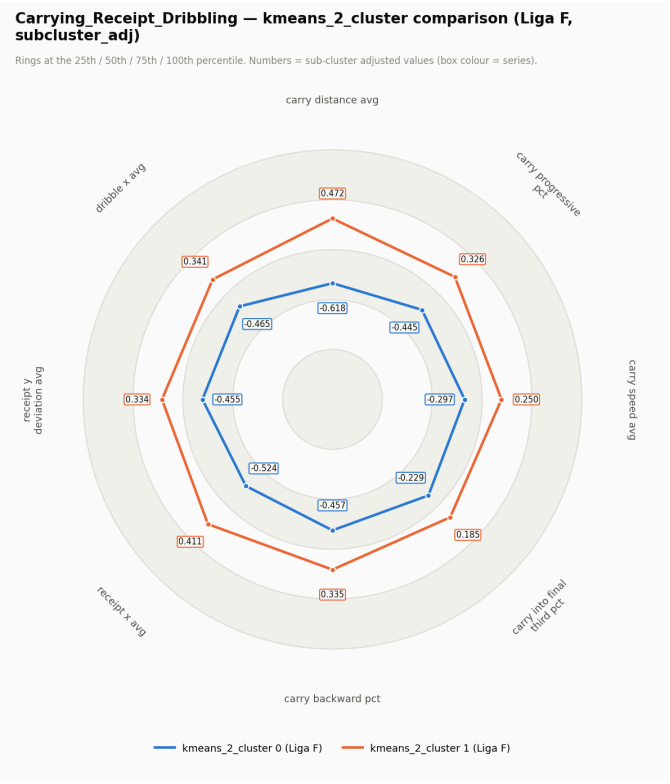


Figure 22: Spain Center Midfields Defensive Carrying, Receipt & Dribbling — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

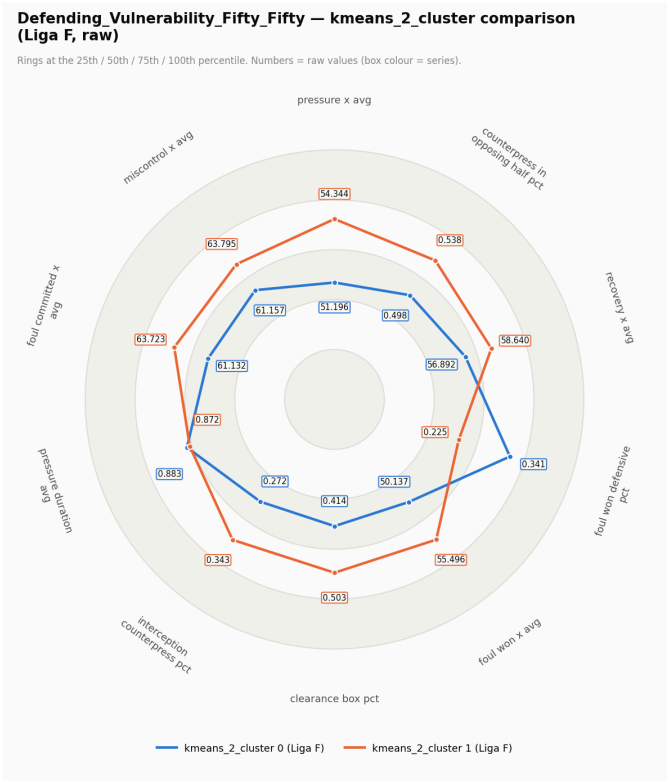


Figure 23: Spain Center Midfields Defensive Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

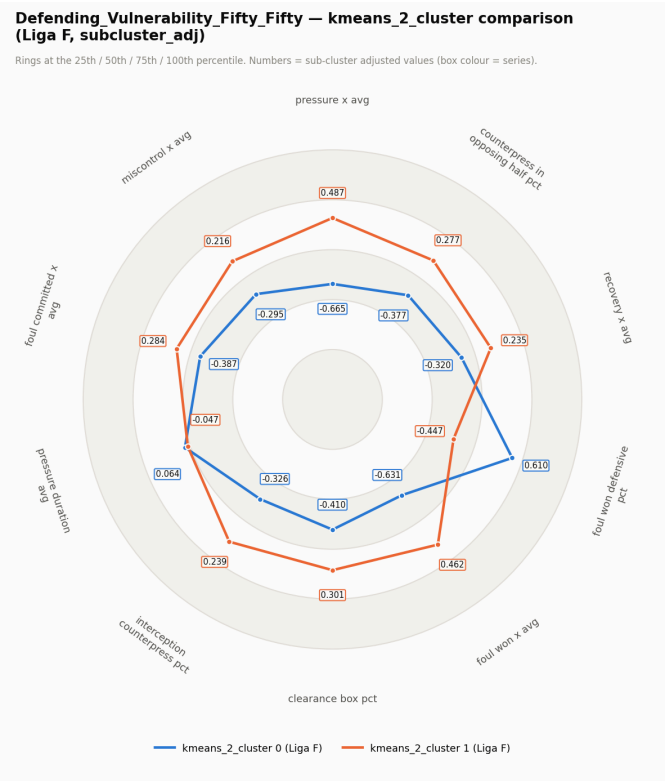


Figure 24: Spain Center Midfields Defensive Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Serie A Women

Passing

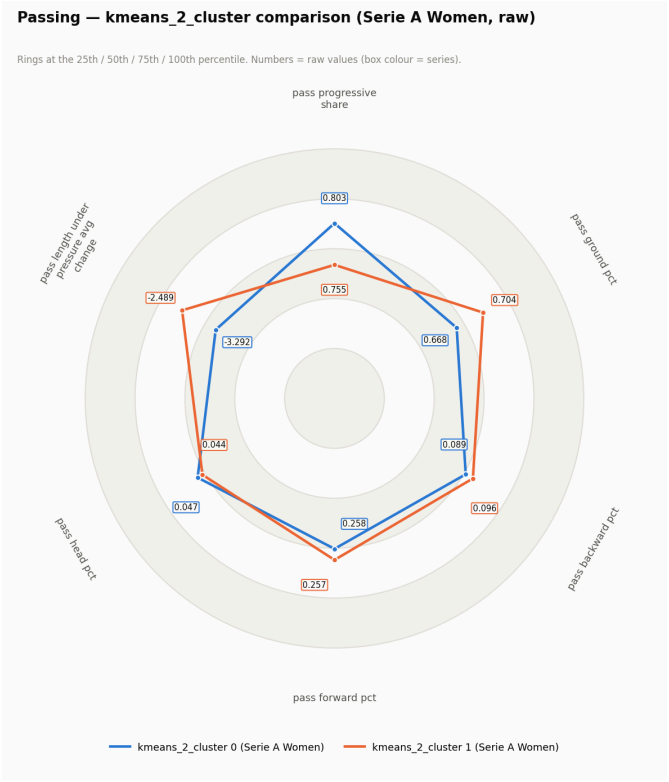


Figure 25: Italy Center Midfields Defensive Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

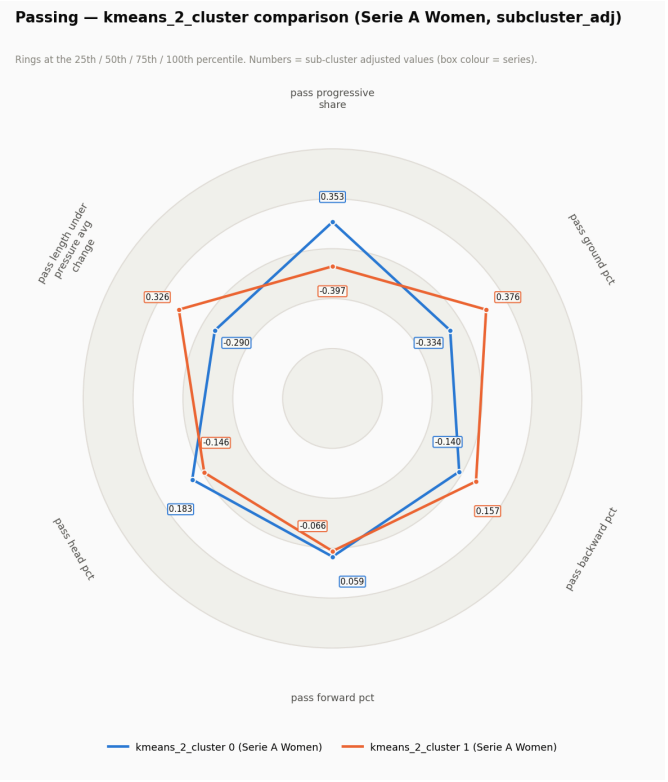


Figure 26: Italy Center Midfields Defensive Passing — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt & Dribbling

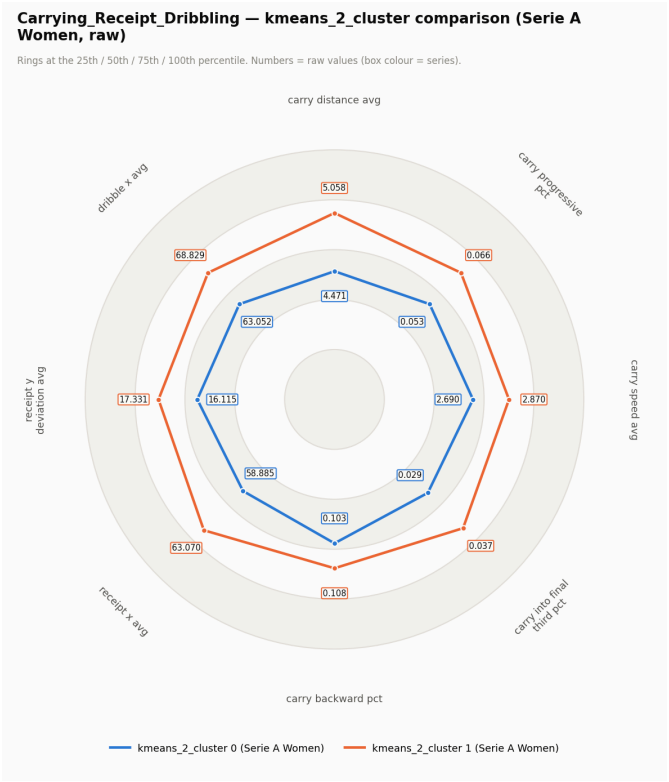


Figure 27: Italy Center Midfields Defensive Carrying, Receipt & Dribbling — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

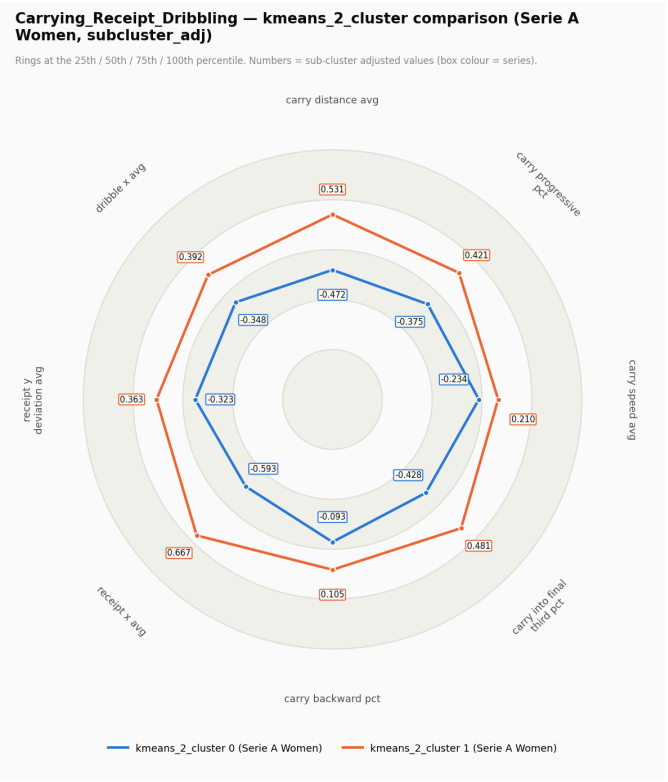


Figure 28: Italy Center Midfields Defensive Carrying, Receipt & Dribbling — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

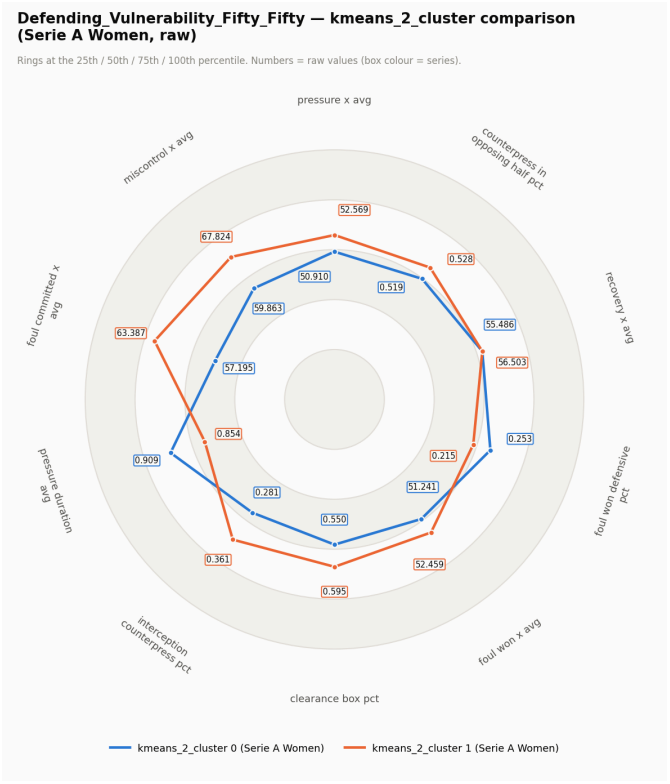


Figure 29: Italy Center Midfields Defensive Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

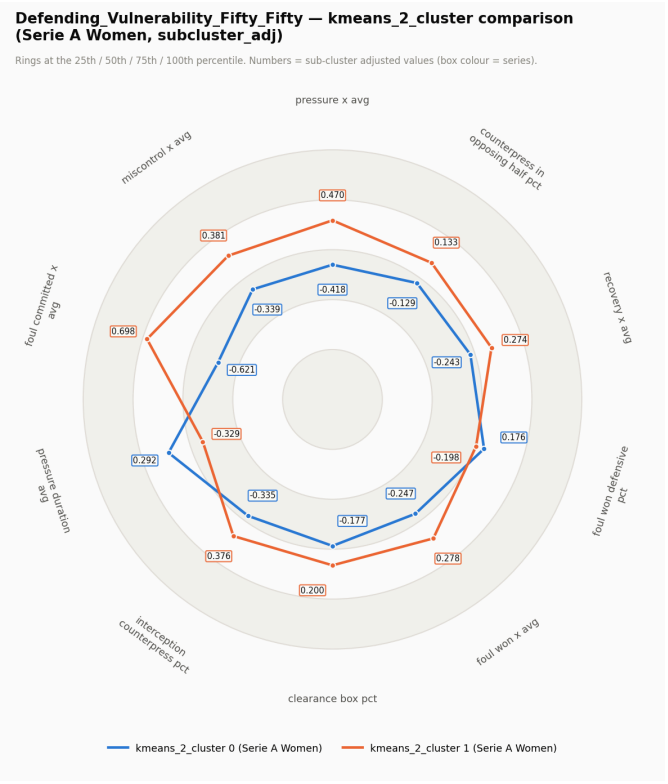


Figure 30: Italy Center Midfields Defensive Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters